

# Rajendra Rawat

Agentic AI · Digital Transformation · Strategic Engineering Leader · Australia

[GitHub](#) | [LinkedIn](#) | [Kaggle](#) | [Website](#)

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## About

Strategic technology leader with nearly two decades of global experience across 20+ verticals including Education and Retail. Operated across North America, EMEA, and APAC, currently based in Australia. I bridge hands-on AI engineering and executive strategy - having advised CIOs, led enterprise-scale digital transformation, and independently built production-grade agentic AI systems.

I have been building AI systems since 2015 (7 years before the ChatGPT wave) from enterprise conversational AI at scale to training language models from scratch and deploying hardened autonomous agents on sovereign local infrastructure.

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## Independent Research & Projects

### ✓ COGNI-BRAIN

#### Hardened agentic deployment on DGX Spark

Nemotron-3-Super-120B running at 23.2 TPS with NemoHermes inside an OpenShell kernel-level sandbox. No cloud, no data leaving the building.

- [View Repository](#)

Demonstrates sovereign AI deployment pattern applicable to regulated industries where data cannot leave organisational boundaries.

### ✓ SAGE-GPT

#### Sanskrit SLM trained entirely from scratch on DGX Spark

7.5M parameter decoder-only Transformer trained on ~140M Sanskrit tokens. Grokking strategy induced for genuine generalisation.

- [View Repository](#)

## ✓ COGNI.CHAT

### Local-first multimodal AI agent platform

Orchestrating Cogni intelligence designed to support the human mind, body, and spirit.

- [Visit cogni.chat](#)

## ✓ FIDUCIARY-OPS-AGENT

### Autonomous enterprise governance agent

Check-then-Act protocol via Gemini 2.5 Flash Lite. Enforces real-time fiduciary risk-alignment.

- [View Repository](#)
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## Work Experience

### 2021 — PRESENT

#### ✓ Tribe Lead · Digital Strategy & R&D

*ASX-listed retail group · Australia*

Led 3-year re-platform of legacy e-commerce to modern cloud MACH architecture. Contributing to AI readiness and agentic AI research within the R&D function.

### 2018 — 2020

#### ✓ Technical Program Lead · Advisor to CIO

*Australian Catholic University (via Espire) · Australia*

Advisor to CIO across 8 global campuses. Deployed AVA conversational AI agent serving students university-wide. Delivered AI-driven campus transformation featured in 2 Microsoft Global Case Studies. Recipient of the Outstanding Contribution to Digital Transformation award.

### 2013 — 2021

#### ✓ Director of Technology · Microsoft & Emerging Tech

*Espire Infolabs · Gurugram, India*

Reporting to CEO. Grew global Microsoft practice to multi-million dollar accounts while incubating AI/IoT Centres of Excellence. Architected the company's first enterprise AI chatbot in 2015 - predating the LLM wave by 7 years capability which evolved into commercial deployments at ACU and Victoria University bots.

### 2006 — 2013

**Consultant**

Microsoft · Hyderabad, India

Architected mission-critical systems for Fortune Global 500: Chevron, Merck, Franklin Templeton, Aviva...

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**Credentials**

| Year | Milestone                        | Issuer              | Link                   |
|------|----------------------------------|---------------------|------------------------|
| 2025 | ✔ AI Agents Intensive Course     | Google · Kaggle     | <a href="#">Verify</a> |
| 2021 | ✔ Azure Data Scientist Associate | Microsoft           | <a href="#">Verify</a> |
| 2021 | ✔ Azure AI Engineer Associate    | Microsoft           | <a href="#">Verify</a> |
| 2021 | Azure Developer Associate        | Microsoft           | <a href="#">Verify</a> |
| 2020 | ✔ Managing ML Projects           | Google Cloud        | <a href="#">Verify</a> |
| 2019 | ✔ Deep Learning Specialisation   | DeepLearning.AI     | <a href="#">Verify</a> |
| 2019 | ✔ Machine Learning Certificate   | Stanford University | <a href="#">Verify</a> |
| 2017 | ✔ Data Science Orientation       | Microsoft · edX     | <a href="#">Verify</a> |

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**Awards**

- ✔ Outstanding Contribution to Digital Transformation (2020) · Australian Catholic University | [View](#)
- Gem of the Year (2019 · 2018) · Espire Infolabs
- Automation Champion (2017) · Espire Infolabs